



Plam Pre

Its finally here! Release date fixed at 6 June. It will be available on Sprint.



Mozilla Fennec

An alpha version of mobile Firefox for Microsoft's Windows Mobile platform is released.

is found on the phone's main menu. Through this application, you can quickly search for and view clips. In the application, when you click on a thumbnail of a video, the phone automatically switches to landscape mode and expands the video.

Summing it up...

This is definitely a fast and easy-to-use smart phone. It is promising enough that comparisons to the iPhone can immediately be drawn. Together with the Palm Pre and the iPhone, it can easily form the holy trinity of smart phones. Oh and since it's exclusively available on Vodafone, we hope to get our hands on it soon in India.

The next step in social location

Nokia has launched the latest version of its mapping services under the Ovi umbrella brand. With this release, Nokia is moving into the mashup domain by making its mapping software open to a greater level of integration, sharing and collaboration with its audience. The erstwhile mapping application known as Nokia Maps Beta 3.0 for the past couple of months, has now got an overhaul with several improvements and enhancements through additional features and services. These include high resolution

satellite and terrain maps – both in 2D and 3D views – 3D landmarks for over 200 cities, rotation, tilting, night view, and fly-overs and fly-throughs.



The application now called Ovi Maps also offers enriched Point Of Interest information sourced from providers such as Lonely Planet, Michelin and Wcities. It will also feature a weather service that provides 24-hour and 5-day forecasts. With this release, Nokia is also trying to move away from standard size maps that are found on most other mapping services, to vector-graphic maps. They seem to be a combination of real images and overlays.

The application has a web version as well if you want to browse through it on your desktop instead of a mobile device. With the web app, you can search for addresses and POIs, find places and save them into favourites, and organise them into collections. This way planning trips will be quite easy. Coupled with weather forecasts, there will not be any unforeseen disasters. With this release, Nokia is also opening up an API called Ovi Maps Player API to independent developers. The API is supposed to be really easy to use and can be used to embed and integrate Ovi Maps on web pages, by using basic JavaScript. It's hoped that social networking web sites

will leverage this API and Nokia's location capabilities to come up with some rich social applications that can then be synched with mobile devices.

spectrum. The equipment, too, is modular and doesn't cost much. New York city with its technology-friendly mind frame provided the perfect setting

for testing of this technology. The company claims to have created a strong network architecture and has resolved issues involved with interference and roaming.

Eco-friendly phone accessories

Sprint is really looking at doing its bit to save

the environment. In its latest Green lineup there are products such as the Solio Mono solar-powered charger and two new cell-phone carrying cases. What's eco-friendly about them, you ask? As the name suggests, the Solio charger lets users store power from the sun or electrical socket allowing customers to recharge their mobile phone anywhere, anytime. So not only are you saving the world, but getting a lot of utility value at the same time. The carrying cases, on the other hand, are made from 100 per cent recycled plastic water bottles.

To supplement the approach and accessories, Sprint has also launched a new green themed microsite (www.sprint.com/green). The web site features details on Sprint's sustainability initiatives such as e-billing options and wireless recycling programs. There are tips such as using mobile GPS to calculate the quickest route to save gas, and even a quiz to check your green-quotient. Incidentally, Sprint is the industry leader when it comes to reuse and recycling of wireless devices. In a single year Sprint rescued more than 16 million phones from ending up in landfills. Instead, they were recycled or reused.

Jack in the box

Samsung has recently released its latest smartphone – Jack – a

